A Full external agreement comparisons

All seven families in this section use the matched construct-specific development-Spearman procedure. Each comparison uses the same 305 recordings; marginal intervals use 2,000 speaker-bootstrap draws (seed 42).

Table 1: Accuracy agreement on the matched cohort.

Method	Reference	N	ρ	95% CI	QWK	95% CI
Human raters	**Human pairwise**	**305**	**0.759**	**[0.710, 0.799]**	**0.642**	**[0.597, 0.685]**
Human raters	**Human vs. other two**	**305**	**0.809**	**[0.769, 0.842]**	**0.704**	**[0.663, 0.743]**
Azure	Model vs. two-rater means	305	0.761	[0.709, 0.804]	0.161	[0.129, 0.196]
Azure	Model vs. three-rater mean	305	0.776	[0.723, 0.820]	0.158	[0.126, 0.193]
`speechocean`	Model vs. two-rater means	305	0.856	[0.821, 0.882]	0.502	[0.451, 0.549]
`speechocean`	Model vs. three-rater mean	305	0.874	[0.839, 0.900]	0.507	[0.452, 0.558]
`korean`	Model vs. two-rater means	305	0.856	[0.822, 0.882]	0.702	[0.662, 0.739]
`korean`	Model vs. three-rater mean	305	0.872	[0.839, 0.898]	0.726	[0.686, 0.763]
`aesop`	Model vs. two-rater means	305	0.852	[0.818, 0.878]	0.241	[0.215, 0.265]
`aesop`	Model vs. three-rater mean	305	0.869	[0.836, 0.894]	0.244	[0.217, 0.269]
`koreanocean`	Model vs. two-rater means	305	0.853	[0.816, 0.882]	0.821	[0.789, 0.847]
`koreanocean`	Model vs. three-rater mean	305	0.870	[0.833, 0.898]	0.860	[0.832, 0.884]
`aesopocean`	Model vs. two-rater means	305	0.872	[0.842, 0.894]	0.598	[0.563, 0.631]
`aesopocean`	Model vs. three-rater mean	305	0.889	[0.859, 0.911]	0.615	[0.579, 0.649]
`koreanaesop`	Model vs. two-rater means	305	0.867	[0.835, 0.891]	0.477	[0.439, 0.512]
`koreanaesop`	Model vs. three-rater mean	305	0.884	[0.853, 0.908]	0.486	[0.448, 0.522]
`aesopkoreanocean`	Model vs. two-rater means	305	0.870	[0.839, 0.894]	0.585	[0.548, 0.620]
`aesopkoreanocean`	Model vs. three-rater mean	305	0.888	[0.857, 0.911]	0.601	[0.563, 0.636]

Human pairwise and other-two statistics average three comparisons; model two-rater statistics average comparisons against the same three pairs. QWK caps out-of-range predictions to 0–100 and rounds half-up; Spearman retains raw predictions. One AESOP accuracy prediction required lower-bound clipping.

Table 2: Fluency agreement on the matched cohort.

Method	Reference	N	ρ	95% CI	QWK	95% CI
Human raters	**Human pairwise**	**305**	**0.747**	**[0.697, 0.791]**	**0.680**	**[0.631, 0.724]**
Human raters	**Human vs. other two**	**305**	**0.807**	**[0.768, 0.840]**	**0.739**	**[0.695, 0.777]**
Azure	Model vs. two-rater means	305	0.633	[0.556, 0.698]	0.078	[0.056, 0.107]
Azure	Model vs. three-rater mean	305	0.649	[0.571, 0.715]	0.077	[0.055, 0.105]
`speechocean`	Model vs. two-rater means	305	0.811	[0.763, 0.848]	0.716	[0.672, 0.752]

Method	Reference	N	ρ	95% CI	QWK	95% CI
`speechocean`	Model vs. three-rater mean	305	0.827	[0.779, 0.863]	0.751	[0.707, 0.786]
`korean`	Model vs. two-rater means	305	0.860	[0.825, 0.888]	0.495	[0.452, 0.535]
`korean`	Model vs. three-rater mean	305	0.879	[0.844, 0.905]	0.510	[0.466, 0.550]
`aesop`	Model vs. two-rater means	305	0.850	[0.813, 0.879]	0.276	[0.247, 0.305]
`aesop`	Model vs. three-rater mean	305	0.868	[0.833, 0.896]	0.283	[0.253, 0.312]
`koreanocean`	Model vs. two-rater means	305	0.840	[0.799, 0.873]	0.585	[0.537, 0.628]
`koreanocean`	Model vs. three-rater mean	305	0.857	[0.817, 0.890]	0.606	[0.557, 0.650]
`aesopocean`	Model vs. two-rater means	305	0.874	[0.842, 0.899]	0.613	[0.575, 0.647]
`aesopocean`	Model vs. three-rater mean	305	0.893	[0.863, 0.917]	0.633	[0.595, 0.667]
`koreanaesop`	Model vs. two-rater means	305	0.876	[0.846, 0.900]	0.462	[0.424, 0.496]
`koreanaesop`	Model vs. three-rater mean	305	0.895	[0.866, 0.917]	0.474	[0.436, 0.509]
`aesopkoreanocean`	Model vs. two-rater means	305	0.874	[0.842, 0.898]	0.527	[0.486, 0.564]
`aesopkoreanocean`	Model vs. three-rater mean	305	0.892	[0.861, 0.916]	0.543	[0.501, 0.580]

Human pairwise and other-two statistics average three comparisons; model two-rater statistics average comparisons against the same three pairs. QWK caps out-of-range predictions to 0–100 and rounds half-up; Spearman retains raw predictions. No prediction required clipping for this construct.

Table 3: Prosody agreement on the matched cohort.

Method	Reference	N	ρ	95% CI	QWK	95% CI
Human raters	**Human pairwise**	**305**	**0.751**	**[0.702, 0.795]**	**0.681**	**[0.634, 0.722]**
Human raters	**Human vs. other two**	**305**	**0.807**	**[0.768, 0.842]**	**0.742**	**[0.701, 0.778]**
Azure	Model vs. two-rater means	305	0.737	[0.672, 0.792]	0.370	[0.318, 0.421]
Azure	Model vs. three-rater mean	305	0.750	[0.684, 0.806]	0.369	[0.318, 0.422]
`speechocean`	Model vs. two-rater means	305	0.819	[0.776, 0.855]	0.597	[0.551, 0.639]
`speechocean`	Model vs. three-rater mean	305	0.837	[0.794, 0.872]	0.621	[0.573, 0.662]
`korean`	Model vs. two-rater means	305	0.874	[0.842, 0.899]	0.489	[0.447, 0.526]
`korean`	Model vs. three-rater mean	305	0.893	[0.862, 0.917]	0.502	[0.460, 0.540]
`aesop`	Model vs. two-rater means	305	0.850	[0.814, 0.878]	0.261	[0.232, 0.288]
`aesop`	Model vs. three-rater mean	305	0.867	[0.833, 0.895]	0.266	[0.237, 0.295]
`koreanocean`	Model vs. two-rater means	305	0.850	[0.812, 0.881]	0.546	[0.501, 0.586]
`koreanocean`	Model vs. three-rater mean	305	0.869	[0.832, 0.900]	0.563	[0.517, 0.604]
`aesopocean`	Model vs. two-rater means	305	0.881	[0.850, 0.905]	0.541	[0.502, 0.576]

Method	Reference	N	ρ	95% CI	QWK	95% CI
`aesopocean`	Model vs. three-rater mean	305	0.899	[0.870, 0.922]	0.557	[0.517, 0.592]
`koreanaesop`	Model vs. two-rater means	305	0.883	[0.852, 0.906]	0.431	[0.394, 0.465]
`koreanaesop`	Model vs. three-rater mean	305	0.902	[0.873, 0.924]	0.442	[0.404, 0.477]
`aesopkoreanocean`	Model vs. two-rater means	305	0.881	[0.850, 0.906]	0.480	[0.440, 0.516]
`aesopkoreanocean`	Model vs. three-rater mean	305	0.900	[0.870, 0.924]	0.493	[0.452, 0.530]

Human pairwise and other-two statistics average three comparisons; model two-rater statistics average comparisons against the same three pairs. QWK caps out-of-range predictions to 0–100 and rounds half-up; Spearman retains raw predictions. No prediction required clipping for this construct.

B Selection-rule sensitivity comparison

Three public-development selection conditions were fixed before this comparison: S selects each construct by Spearman on $\{0.001, 0.01, 0.1, 1, 10, 100\}$; D selects by development accuracy MAE on the same grid; H selects by accuracy MAE on $\{0.00005, 0.0005, 0.005, 0.05, 0.5, 5\}$. The historical summed-loss penalties $\{0.1, 1, 10, 100, 1000, 10000\}$ were divided by the original 2,000 SpeechOcean training utterances to express the same penalty strength under normalized loss. That fixed conversion is applied to every family, not divided again by its sample count. Corpus-balanced weights, training-only scaling, feature combinations, and partitions are identical across conditions. Development metrics are averaged over the included corpora. S breaks ties by lower MAE, then larger penalty; D and H break ties by larger penalty. Accuracy MAE selects one penalty per representation combination, so fluency and prosody share the penalty selected for their common XLS-R + XEUS features; their output coefficients remain separate. H reproduces the historical grid within the matched fitting convention, not every historical implementation detail. All 21 family–condition combinations completed all 305 recordings. The main table displays the external leaders across S, D, and H, including every configuration within .001 of the highest unrounded correlation or QWK for each construct. The complete matrix below preserves the common-condition comparisons; the matched SpeechOcean refit replaces the historical deployment in S. No private ratings entered coefficient estimation, tuning, or calibration. Choosing a deployment from these external comparisons would be a post-evaluation choice. The separate historical deployed SpeechOcean scores remain in the released aggregate file and are not substituted for the matched S row. Historical-grid DAMAE improves koreanocean two-rater fluency QWK from 0.585 to 0.744 and prosody QWK from 0.546 to 0.675, while the corresponding correlations change from 0.840 to 0.838 and 0.850 to 0.840. The fluency QWK point estimate is slightly above the human baseline of 0.739; no paired superiority test is reported for that sensitivity contrast. Different rules therefore trade rank association against numerical agreement, without establishing one uniformly best condition. The intervals below are marginal, not intervals for condition differences; the 90-contrast adjustment in the following section concerns the matched S subset only. The released CSV also includes every three-rater result and its interval.

Table 4: Accuracy: all selection conditions against two-rater consensus ($N = 305$).

Family	Rule	ρ	95% CI	QWK	95% CI
speechocean	S	0.856	[0.821, 0.882]	0.502	[0.451, 0.549]
speechocean	D	0.856	[0.821, 0.882]	0.502	[0.451, 0.549]
speechocean	H	0.844	[0.807, 0.872]	0.546	[0.494, 0.592]
korean	S	0.856	[0.822, 0.882]	0.702	[0.662, 0.739]
korean	D	0.856	[0.822, 0.882]	0.702	[0.662, 0.739]
korean	H	0.853	[0.820, 0.881]	0.672	[0.631, 0.711]
aesop	S	0.852	[0.818, 0.878]	0.241	[0.215, 0.265]
aesop	D	0.864	[0.832, 0.888]	0.239	[0.214, 0.264]
aesop	H	0.863	[0.830, 0.887]	0.239	[0.214, 0.264]
koreanocean	S	0.853	[0.816, 0.882]	0.821	[0.789, 0.847]

Family	Rule	ρ	95% CI	QWK	95% CI
koreanocean	D	0.841	[0.802, 0.871]	0.798	[0.764, 0.827]
koreanocean	H	0.849	[0.811, 0.879]	0.819	[0.788, 0.846]
aesopocean	S	0.872	[0.842, 0.894]	0.598	[0.563, 0.631]
aesopocean	D	0.865	[0.833, 0.890]	0.628	[0.593, 0.662]
aesopocean	H	0.872	[0.841, 0.894]	0.607	[0.572, 0.640]
koreanaesop	S	0.867	[0.835, 0.891]	0.477	[0.439, 0.512]
koreanaesop	D	0.867	[0.835, 0.891]	0.477	[0.439, 0.512]
koreanaesop	H	0.867	[0.836, 0.891]	0.472	[0.435, 0.508]
aesopkoreanocean	S	0.870	[0.839, 0.894]	0.585	[0.548, 0.620]
aesopkoreanocean	D	0.862	[0.829, 0.888]	0.576	[0.537, 0.613]
aesopkoreanocean	H	0.857	[0.824, 0.884]	0.575	[0.537, 0.611]

Table 5: Fluency: all selection conditions against two-rater consensus ($N = 305$).

Family	Rule	ρ	95% CI	QWK	95% CI
speechocean	S	0.811	[0.763, 0.848]	0.716	[0.672, 0.752]
speechocean	D	0.847	[0.806, 0.878]	0.629	[0.585, 0.666]
speechocean	H	0.842	[0.801, 0.874]	0.670	[0.627, 0.706]
korean	S	0.860	[0.825, 0.888]	0.495	[0.452, 0.535]
korean	D	0.860	[0.825, 0.888]	0.495	[0.452, 0.535]
korean	H	0.859	[0.825, 0.886]	0.501	[0.458, 0.538]
aesop	S	0.850	[0.813, 0.879]	0.276	[0.247, 0.305]
aesop	D	0.855	[0.819, 0.883]	0.312	[0.279, 0.342]
aesop	H	0.859	[0.823, 0.885]	0.315	[0.282, 0.346]
koreanocean	S	0.840	[0.799, 0.873]	0.585	[0.537, 0.628]
koreanocean	D	0.846	[0.808, 0.877]	0.714	[0.672, 0.751]
koreanocean	H	0.838	[0.799, 0.870]	0.744	[0.702, 0.779]
aesopocean	S	0.874	[0.842, 0.899]	0.613	[0.575, 0.647]
aesopocean	D	0.874	[0.842, 0.899]	0.613	[0.575, 0.647]
aesopocean	H	0.862	[0.828, 0.890]	0.612	[0.574, 0.647]
koreanaesop	S	0.876	[0.846, 0.900]	0.462	[0.424, 0.496]
koreanaesop	D	0.876	[0.846, 0.900]	0.462	[0.424, 0.496]
koreanaesop	H	0.878	[0.848, 0.901]	0.469	[0.431, 0.502]
aesopkoreanocean	S	0.874	[0.842, 0.898]	0.527	[0.486, 0.564]
aesopkoreanocean	D	0.877	[0.846, 0.902]	0.577	[0.539, 0.612]
aesopkoreanocean	H	0.871	[0.839, 0.897]	0.591	[0.552, 0.626]

Table 6: Prosody: all selection conditions against two-rater consensus ($N = 305$).

Family	Rule	ρ	95% CI	QWK	95% CI
speechocean	S	0.819	[0.776, 0.855]	0.597	[0.551, 0.639]
speechocean	D	0.850	[0.813, 0.880]	0.545	[0.501, 0.585]
speechocean	H	0.847	[0.809, 0.878]	0.570	[0.525, 0.610]
korean	S	0.874	[0.842, 0.899]	0.489	[0.447, 0.526]
korean	D	0.874	[0.842, 0.899]	0.489	[0.447, 0.526]
korean	H	0.872	[0.840, 0.896]	0.493	[0.452, 0.531]
aesop	S	0.850	[0.814, 0.878]	0.261	[0.232, 0.288]

Family	Rule	ρ	95% CI	QWK	95% CI
aesop	D	0.855	[0.820, 0.882]	0.280	[0.249, 0.309]
aesop	H	0.858	[0.824, 0.884]	0.283	[0.252, 0.312]
koreanocean	S	0.850	[0.812, 0.881]	0.546	[0.501, 0.586]
koreanocean	D	0.851	[0.815, 0.882]	0.641	[0.599, 0.680]
koreanocean	H	0.840	[0.802, 0.872]	0.675	[0.632, 0.712]
aesopocean	S	0.881	[0.850, 0.905]	0.541	[0.502, 0.576]
aesopocean	D	0.870	[0.838, 0.895]	0.497	[0.457, 0.531]
aesopocean	H	0.861	[0.827, 0.888]	0.481	[0.440, 0.516]
koreanaesop	S	0.883	[0.852, 0.906]	0.431	[0.394, 0.465]
koreanaesop	D	0.883	[0.852, 0.906]	0.431	[0.394, 0.465]
koreanaesop	H	0.883	[0.853, 0.906]	0.433	[0.397, 0.468]
aesopkoreanocean	S	0.881	[0.850, 0.906]	0.480	[0.440, 0.516]
aesopkoreanocean	D	0.879	[0.847, 0.904]	0.505	[0.467, 0.541]
aesopkoreanocean	H	0.872	[0.839, 0.898]	0.518	[0.479, 0.554]

AESOP accuracy required lower-bound QWK clipping for one prediction under S and two predictions each under D and H; all other combinations required none. Spearman retained raw predictions. Counts apply to both reference sizes.

C Paired differences and score distributions

The same 305 recordings were jointly resampled 200,000 times (seed 42), treating each distinct recording URL as one speaker. System and human statistics use the same three two-rater reference pairs; differences are recomputed within each replicate. Adjusted percentile endpoints use $0.025/90$ and $1 - 0.025/90$ for the 90 matched-Spearman contrasts. The independent seed-2026 run agrees on 89 of 90 adjusted interval-exclusion decisions. The exception is matched SpeechOcean prosody correlation versus Azure: its adjusted lower endpoint is 0.000027 with seed 42 and -0.002153 with seed 2026; that contrast is treated as borderline. The largest endpoint difference between seeds is 0.00367. Each adjusted tail contains approximately 56 draws, so percentile endpoints remain Monte Carlo approximations. All point estimates match the current matched-Spearman export. These post-evaluation intervals condition on the panel and fitted models; their adjustment does not cover the sensitivity-condition search. No private scores were used for fitting or calibration.

C.1 Accuracy differences

System	Reference	Metric	Difference	95% CI	Adjusted CI
azure	Human	ρ	-0.049	[-0.096, -0.005]	[-0.137, 0.027]
azure	Human	QWK	-0.543	[-0.580, -0.504]	[-0.606, -0.471]
speechocean	Human	ρ	+0.046	[0.016, 0.076]	[-0.008, 0.102]
speechocean	Human	QWK	-0.202	[-0.249, -0.155]	[-0.284, -0.118]
speechocean	Azure	ρ	+0.095	[0.054, 0.139]	[0.023, 0.178]
speechocean	Azure	QWK	+0.341	[0.299, 0.381]	[0.267, 0.410]
korean	Human	ρ	+0.046	[0.018, 0.075]	[-0.004, 0.101]
korean	Human	QWK	-0.002	[-0.041, 0.037]	[-0.071, 0.066]
korean	Azure	ρ	+0.095	[0.055, 0.139]	[0.025, 0.177]
korean	Azure	QWK	+0.541	[0.500, 0.580]	[0.470, 0.609]
aesop	Human	ρ	+0.043	[0.012, 0.074]	[-0.013, 0.101]
aesop	Human	QWK	-0.463	[-0.493, -0.431]	[-0.515, -0.405]
aesop	Azure	ρ	+0.092	[0.054, 0.132]	[0.028, 0.169]
aesop	Azure	QWK	+0.080	[0.053, 0.105]	[0.030, 0.122]
koreanocean	Human	ρ	+0.044	[0.013, 0.074]	[-0.012, 0.099]
koreanocean	Human	QWK	+0.116	[0.082, 0.152]	[0.055, 0.181]

System	Reference	Metric	Difference	95% CI	Adjusted CI
koreanocean	Azure	ρ	+0.093	[0.051, 0.137]	[0.020, 0.176]
koreanocean	Azure	QWK	+0.660	[0.626, 0.690]	[0.600, 0.712]
aesopocean	Human	ρ	+0.062	[0.033, 0.093]	[0.010, 0.119]
aesopocean	Human	QWK	-0.106	[-0.140, -0.071]	[-0.165, -0.045]
aesopocean	Azure	ρ	+0.111	[0.071, 0.155]	[0.043, 0.195]
aesopocean	Azure	QWK	+0.437	[0.402, 0.470]	[0.375, 0.495]
koreanaesop	Human	ρ	+0.057	[0.028, 0.088]	[0.005, 0.114]
koreanaesop	Human	QWK	-0.227	[-0.261, -0.193]	[-0.287, -0.167]
koreanaesop	Azure	ρ	+0.106	[0.066, 0.150]	[0.037, 0.191]
koreanaesop	Azure	QWK	+0.316	[0.281, 0.350]	[0.254, 0.376]
aesopkoreanocean	Human	ρ	+0.061	[0.031, 0.091]	[0.009, 0.118]
aesopkoreanocean	Human	QWK	-0.119	[-0.153, -0.084]	[-0.179, -0.058]
aesopkoreanocean	Azure	ρ	+0.110	[0.070, 0.154]	[0.041, 0.194]
aesopkoreanocean	Azure	QWK	+0.425	[0.389, 0.459]	[0.360, 0.486]

C.2 Fluency differences

System	Reference	Metric	Difference	95% CI	Adjusted CI
azure	Human	ρ	-0.174	[-0.244, -0.110]	[-0.304, -0.067]
azure	Human	QWK	-0.661	[-0.697, -0.621]	[-0.723, -0.588]
speechocean	Human	ρ	+0.004	[-0.036, 0.041]	[-0.069, 0.068]
speechocean	Human	QWK	-0.023	[-0.068, 0.021]	[-0.103, 0.055]
speechocean	Azure	ρ	+0.178	[0.113, 0.247]	[0.066, 0.305]
speechocean	Azure	QWK	+0.638	[0.601, 0.671]	[0.570, 0.695]
korean	Human	ρ	+0.054	[0.022, 0.085]	[-0.002, 0.111]
korean	Human	QWK	-0.244	[-0.281, -0.208]	[-0.308, -0.179]
korean	Azure	ρ	+0.228	[0.164, 0.297]	[0.121, 0.355]
korean	Azure	QWK	+0.417	[0.379, 0.452]	[0.351, 0.478]
aesop	Human	ρ	+0.044	[0.009, 0.077]	[-0.017, 0.104]
aesop	Human	QWK	-0.463	[-0.494, -0.430]	[-0.517, -0.403]
aesop	Azure	ρ	+0.218	[0.157, 0.284]	[0.116, 0.342]
aesop	Azure	QWK	+0.198	[0.174, 0.221]	[0.155, 0.238]
koreanocean	Human	ρ	+0.033	[-0.004, 0.068]	[-0.034, 0.096]
koreanocean	Human	QWK	-0.154	[-0.195, -0.114]	[-0.227, -0.084]
koreanocean	Azure	ρ	+0.207	[0.140, 0.279]	[0.094, 0.339]
koreanocean	Azure	QWK	+0.507	[0.464, 0.546]	[0.428, 0.575]
aesopocean	Human	ρ	+0.068	[0.038, 0.098]	[0.015, 0.123]
aesopocean	Human	QWK	-0.126	[-0.159, -0.093]	[-0.184, -0.066]
aesopocean	Azure	ρ	+0.242	[0.180, 0.310]	[0.139, 0.369]
aesopocean	Azure	QWK	+0.535	[0.501, 0.566]	[0.473, 0.590]
koreanaesop	Human	ρ	+0.069	[0.040, 0.099]	[0.019, 0.124]
koreanaesop	Human	QWK	-0.277	[-0.311, -0.243]	[-0.335, -0.216]
koreanaesop	Azure	ρ	+0.243	[0.182, 0.311]	[0.142, 0.369]
koreanaesop	Azure	QWK	+0.384	[0.350, 0.416]	[0.325, 0.439]
aesopkoreanocean	Human	ρ	+0.067	[0.037, 0.098]	[0.015, 0.123]
aesopkoreanocean	Human	QWK	-0.212	[-0.247, -0.179]	[-0.273, -0.152]
aesopkoreanocean	Azure	ρ	+0.241	[0.177, 0.311]	[0.136, 0.370]
aesopkoreanocean	Azure	QWK	+0.449	[0.412, 0.482]	[0.382, 0.508]

C.3 Prosody differences

System	Reference	Metric	Difference	95% CI	Adjusted CI
azure	Human	ρ	-0.070	[-0.124, -0.023]	[-0.172, 0.010]
azure	Human	QWK	-0.372	[-0.419, -0.325]	[-0.455, -0.289]
speechocean	Human	ρ	+0.012	[-0.023, 0.044]	[-0.051, 0.068]
speechocean	Human	QWK	-0.144	[-0.188, -0.101]	[-0.222, -0.067]
speechocean	Azure	ρ	+0.082	[0.033, 0.135]	[0.000, 0.183]
speechocean	Azure	QWK	+0.228	[0.173, 0.282]	[0.129, 0.323]
korean	Human	ρ	+0.067	[0.039, 0.096]	[0.018, 0.120]
korean	Human	QWK	-0.253	[-0.287, -0.220]	[-0.312, -0.193]
korean	Azure	ρ	+0.137	[0.098, 0.183]	[0.073, 0.225]
korean	Azure	QWK	+0.119	[0.077, 0.160]	[0.043, 0.189]
aesop	Human	ρ	+0.043	[0.012, 0.073]	[-0.012, 0.097]
aesop	Human	QWK	-0.481	[-0.510, -0.451]	[-0.530, -0.427]
aesop	Azure	ρ	+0.113	[0.073, 0.159]	[0.048, 0.200]
aesop	Azure	QWK	-0.109	[-0.147, -0.072]	[-0.176, -0.044]
koreanocean	Human	ρ	+0.042	[0.010, 0.074]	[-0.017, 0.098]
koreanocean	Human	QWK	-0.196	[-0.232, -0.161]	[-0.259, -0.135]
koreanocean	Azure	ρ	+0.113	[0.069, 0.163]	[0.040, 0.208]
koreanocean	Azure	QWK	+0.176	[0.127, 0.223]	[0.088, 0.258]
aesopocean	Human	ρ	+0.073	[0.048, 0.100]	[0.029, 0.123]
aesopocean	Human	QWK	-0.201	[-0.232, -0.170]	[-0.255, -0.146]
aesopocean	Azure	ρ	+0.144	[0.099, 0.195]	[0.072, 0.243]
aesopocean	Azure	QWK	+0.171	[0.127, 0.213]	[0.092, 0.244]
koreanaesop	Human	ρ	+0.076	[0.049, 0.104]	[0.029, 0.128]
koreanaesop	Human	QWK	-0.311	[-0.342, -0.279]	[-0.365, -0.254]
koreanaesop	Azure	ρ	+0.146	[0.105, 0.194]	[0.080, 0.238]
koreanaesop	Azure	QWK	+0.062	[0.022, 0.100]	[-0.009, 0.128]
aesopkoreanocean	Human	ρ	+0.074	[0.047, 0.101]	[0.027, 0.124]
aesopkoreanocean	Human	QWK	-0.262	[-0.293, -0.231]	[-0.315, -0.208]
aesopkoreanocean	Azure	ρ	+0.144	[0.101, 0.194]	[0.074, 0.240]
aesopkoreanocean	Azure	QWK	+0.111	[0.068, 0.151]	[0.034, 0.181]

C.4 Score distributions

Means, sample standard deviations, bias, and MAE use unrounded predictions on the 0–100 scale against the three-rater mean; no recalibration is fitted.

Construct	System	Mean	SD	Bias	MAE
Accuracy	azure	89.29	7.50	23.63	23.63
Accuracy	speechocean	73.57	6.14	7.90	8.96
Accuracy	korean	58.57	12.39	-7.10	7.66
Accuracy	aesop	38.49	13.31	-27.17	27.17
Accuracy	koreanocean	64.85	9.77	-0.81	4.38
Accuracy	aesopocean	55.27	11.66	-10.40	10.51
Accuracy	koreanaesop	50.09	14.23	-15.58	15.59
Accuracy	aesopkoreanocean	54.37	12.52	-11.30	11.38
Fluency	azure	94.18	5.87	27.88	27.88
Fluency	speechocean	64.67	7.37	-1.63	5.26
Fluency	korean	53.31	10.75	-12.99	12.99
Fluency	aesop	44.43	10.97	-21.87	21.87
Fluency	koreanocean	57.68	8.45	-8.62	8.74
Fluency	aesopocean	56.63	10.99	-9.67	9.79
Fluency	koreanaesop	51.09	12.44	-15.21	15.21
Fluency	aesopkoreanocean	54.18	10.50	-12.12	12.13
Prosody	azure	77.13	6.15	10.57	11.04

Construct	System	Mean	SD	Bias	MAE
Prosody	speechocean	60.79	6.81	-5.76	6.70
Prosody	korean	53.31	10.75	-13.25	13.25
Prosody	aesop	44.14	10.62	-22.42	22.42
Prosody	koreanocean	56.89	8.32	-9.66	9.72
Prosody	aesopocean	55.25	9.89	-11.31	11.33
Prosody	koreanaesop	50.26	12.36	-16.29	16.29
Prosody	aesopkoreanocean	53.05	10.42	-13.50	13.50

D Public-development comparisons

The matched seven-family experiment uses fixed representation combinations and penalty selection over included-corpus development sets. All entries are development Spearman correlations, not final-test results. SpeechOcean rows here use the same matched fitting procedure as the revised main external comparison; the original historical deployment is reported separately. Korean fluency and prosody share a source target. J-AESOP has only 36 development recordings, so large correlations should not be read as precise generalization estimates.

Construct	Family	SpeechOcean (500)	Korean (636)	J-AESOP (36)
Accuracy	speechocean	0.816	0.699	0.967
Accuracy	korean	0.735	0.759	0.969
Accuracy	aesop	0.659	0.673	0.987
Accuracy	koreanocean	0.808	0.755	0.964
Accuracy	aesopocean	0.807	0.715	0.970
Accuracy	koreanaesop	0.683	0.755	0.976
Accuracy	aesopkoreanocean	0.804	0.748	0.971
Fluency	speechocean	0.886	0.668	0.856
Fluency	korean	0.837	0.778	0.919
Fluency	aesop	0.682	0.586	0.966
Fluency	koreanocean	0.876	0.770	0.924
Fluency	aesopocean	0.881	0.728	0.952
Fluency	koreanaesop	0.834	0.779	0.959
Fluency	aesopkoreanocean	0.875	0.769	0.953
Prosody	speechocean	0.890	0.653	0.929
Prosody	korean	0.829	0.778	0.938
Prosody	aesop	0.685	0.544	0.975
Prosody	koreanocean	0.876	0.771	0.949
Prosody	aesopocean	0.878	0.747	0.971
Prosody	koreanaesop	0.830	0.777	0.973
Prosody	aesopkoreanocean	0.872	0.770	0.974

E Korean supervision and representation sensitivity

E.1 Korean scoring and target mapping

Han, Chung, and Kim (2024; main-paper reference) define two 1–5 ratings: pronunciation accuracy and prosodic fluency. Accuracy addresses segmental clarity and errors; prosodic fluency combines stress, rhythm, intonation, speed, and pausing. The stored fields are `articulationScore` and `prosodyScore`. The second field supplies both fluency and prosody targets in the present implementation. Mapping $2.5(y-1)$ produces 0, 2.5, 5, 7.5, and 10 from the five integer levels; mapping does not equate the rubric with SpeechOcean or create an independent fluency annotation. Korean-only heads use the same features and targets for both constructs, yielding identical predictions in the evaluated configuration.

Source	Mapped	Accuracy (paraphrased)	Prosodic fluency (paraphrased)
1	0	Extensive segmental difficulty; understanding is hard.	Strongly disrupted prosody, very slow delivery, excessive pauses.
2	2.5	Frequent errors substantially burden understanding.	Awkward prosody and slow delivery with prolonged, poorly placed pauses.
3	5	Recurring errors interfere with understanding.	Uneven prosody and rate, with frequent or misplaced breaks.
4	7.5	Minor errors with little intelligibility impact.	Mostly steady delivery with mild prosodic or pausing irregularities.
5	10	Clear segments without noticeable errors.	Natural prosody, rate, and phrase boundaries.

E.2 Ablation protocol

The protocol was recorded before fitting on October 18, 2026 (repository: `results/ablation-mac-v1/PROTOCOL.md`). The completed public-development sweep crossed seven training families, three constructs, and all 15 nonempty subsets of four feature blocks, giving 315 configurations and 945 corpus-level comparisons. X denotes XEUS, R XLS-R, P PhoneticXeus embeddings, and I the 17 phone diagnostics; I still requires PhoneticXeus inference, so omitting P does not necessarily avoid that encoder. Existing speaker-disjoint partitions, corpus-balanced weights, training-only standardization, and block gains were preserved. Each configuration selected a penalty from $\{0.001, 0.01, 0.1, 1, 10, 100\}$ using equal-weight mean Spearman across all three development corpora, breaking ties by lower macro MAE and then larger penalty. This differs from the earlier included-corpus tuning; no corpus in these tables is an untouched cross-corpus test. Private recordings and ratings were excluded from fitting and selection.

Each candidate was compared with the fixed-feature baseline refitted under the same sweep protocol (X+P+I for accuracy, X+R otherwise). Candidates within 0.01 of the numerical best were shortlisted. Promotion required macro Spearman gain at least 0.01, no corpus correlation loss exceeding 0.02, no corpus MAE increase exceeding 0.10 on the 0–10 scale, and a positive lower 95% paired speaker-bootstrap bound (2,000 draws, seed 42). Fewer blocks were preferred where benefits were inconclusive. These screening gates do not constitute correction for all search comparisons. Deployed heads were not automatically replaced.

The decision table distinguishes numerical maxima from candidates passing the complete gate. Two AESOP-only alternatives passed: X+P for fluency and X+P+I for prosody. Their macro gains over the refitted AESOP baselines were 0.0341 (95% interval [0.0118, 0.0619]) for fluency and 0.0389 ([0.0161, 0.0638]) for prosody. Both exceed the 0.01 within-family threshold. Neither became the overall construct selection, and neither was substituted into the external seven-family evaluation. The overall retained choices were koreanocean X+P+I accuracy and aesopkoreanocean X+R fluency/prosody. Thus retaining the overall configurations does not mean that no individual family improved. XEUS-only macro correlations for the selected families were 0.8407 for koreanocean accuracy and 0.8644/0.8680 for aesopkoreanocean fluency/prosody, compared with 0.8424 and 0.8660/0.8721 for the retained combinations. These small development differences do not establish that all additional blocks are necessary; no XEUS-only private evaluation or matched resource benchmark is reported. The retained choices reflect the recorded development rule, not independently established representation optimality. Matrices report all 315 macro correlations; the accompanying CSV preserves all 945 corpus-specific correlations and MAEs.

Family	Construct	Numerical best	Best ρ	Retained/gated	Promotion
speechocean	accuracy	X+P+I	0.8276	X+P+I	No
speechocean	fluency	X+P+I	0.8655	X+R	No
speechocean	prosody	X+I	0.8640	X+R	No
korean	accuracy	X+R+I	0.8322	X+P+I	No
korean	fluency	X+I	0.8544	X+R	No
korean	prosody	X	0.8560	X+R	No
aesop	accuracy	X+P+I	0.7813	X+P+I	No
aesop	fluency	X+P	0.7961	X+P	Yes
aesop	prosody	X+P+I	0.7893	X+P+I	Yes
koreanocean	accuracy	X+P+I	0.8424	X+P+I	No

Family	Construct	Numerical best	Best ρ	Retained/gated	Promotion
koreanocean	fluency	X+P	0.8685	X+R	No
koreanocean	prosody	X+P+I	0.8691	X+R	No
aesopocean	accuracy	X+P+I	0.8309	X+P+I	No
aesopocean	fluency	X+R+P+I	0.8654	X+R	No
aesopocean	prosody	X+R+P+I	0.8653	X+R	No
koreanaesop	accuracy	X+R	0.8337	X+P+I	No
koreanaesop	fluency	X+R+P	0.8600	X+R	No
koreanaesop	prosody	X+R	0.8599	X+R	No
aesopkoreanocean	accuracy	X+R+P+I	0.8425	X+P+I	No
aesopkoreanocean	fluency	X+R+P+I	0.8710	X+R	No
aesopkoreanocean	prosody	X+R	0.8721	X+R	No

E.3 Accuracy representation matrix

Columns S, K, A, SK, SA, KA, and SKA denote the seven corpus families in that order. Values are macro development Spearman correlations.

Features	S	K	A	SK	SA	KA	SKA
X	0.8208	0.8321	0.7655	0.8407	0.8226	0.8318	0.8336
R	0.6715	0.7460	0.3186	0.7646	0.7465	0.7766	0.7972
P	0.7860	0.7366	0.7292	0.8228	0.8065	0.7600	0.8273
I	0.6080	0.6742	0.6201	0.6961	0.3225	0.5164	0.4372
X+R	0.7957	0.8297	0.7414	0.8322	0.8257	0.8337	0.8361
X+P	0.8190	0.8030	0.7732	0.8350	0.8231	0.8159	0.8354
X+I	0.8253	0.8321	0.7522	0.8411	0.8249	0.8149	0.8362
R+P	0.7505	0.7690	0.6650	0.8192	0.8008	0.7871	0.8287
R+I	0.7290	0.7875	0.5625	0.7968	0.7765	0.7830	0.8085
P+I	0.7991	0.7750	0.7582	0.8308	0.8155	0.7171	0.8356
X+R+P	0.7962	0.8104	0.7453	0.8280	0.8235	0.8225	0.8350
X+R+I	0.7984	0.8322	0.7223	0.8363	0.8266	0.8183	0.8382
X+P+I	0.8276	0.8212	0.7813	0.8424	0.8309	0.8048	0.8409
R+P+I	0.7723	0.7932	0.7065	0.8260	0.8104	0.7740	0.8381
X+R+P+I	0.8048	0.8218	0.7565	0.8363	0.8304	0.8132	0.8425

E.4 Fluency representation matrix

Columns S, K, A, SK, SA, KA, and SKA denote the seven corpus families in that order. Values are macro development Spearman correlations.

Features	S	K	A	SK	SA	KA	SKA
X	0.8551	0.8543	0.7782	0.8630	0.8588	0.8545	0.8644
R	0.7312	0.7734	0.4373	0.8213	0.8000	0.8100	0.8319
P	0.8428	0.7912	0.7640	0.8592	0.8495	0.8127	0.8599
I	0.6288	0.6757	0.6577	0.6876	0.4060	0.5606	0.5002
X+R	0.8364	0.8444	0.7620	0.8567	0.8599	0.8574	0.8660
X+P	0.8613	0.8465	0.7961	0.8685	0.8645	0.8578	0.8702
X+I	0.8569	0.8544	0.7671	0.8618	0.8576	0.8538	0.8662
R+P	0.8178	0.8162	0.7153	0.8555	0.8498	0.8415	0.8653
R+I	0.7833	0.8076	0.6342	0.8407	0.8291	0.8200	0.8458
P+I	0.8469	0.8099	0.7748	0.8570	0.8511	0.8004	0.8593
X+R+P	0.8481	0.8458	0.7730	0.8609	0.8654	0.8600	0.8696
X+R+I	0.8443	0.8516	0.7400	0.8593	0.8598	0.8533	0.8652
X+P+I	0.8655	0.8508	0.7866	0.8666	0.8644	0.8498	0.8677
R+P+I	0.8340	0.8283	0.7268	0.8576	0.8515	0.8333	0.8653
X+R+P+I	0.8509	0.8481	0.7635	0.8639	0.8654	0.8556	0.8710

E.5 Prosody representation matrix

Columns S, K, A, SK, SA, KA, and SKA denote the seven corpus families in that order. Values are macro development Spearman correlations.

Features	S	K	A	SK	SA	KA	SKA
X	0.8631	0.8560	0.7817	0.8688	0.8599	0.8573	0.8680
R	0.7489	0.7740	0.3583	0.8172	0.7891	0.8178	0.8377
P	0.8313	0.7768	0.7520	0.8503	0.8416	0.7970	0.8526
I	0.6228	0.6834	0.6322	0.6960	0.4179	0.5379	0.5035
X+R	0.8410	0.8483	0.7504	0.8657	0.8653	0.8599	0.8721
X+P	0.8620	0.8384	0.7872	0.8664	0.8615	0.8508	0.8681
X+I	0.8640	0.8524	0.7627	0.8659	0.8609	0.8499	0.8693
R+P	0.8077	0.8070	0.6886	0.8517	0.8409	0.8296	0.8586
R+I	0.7789	0.8076	0.5893	0.8412	0.8229	0.8208	0.8498
P+I	0.8361	0.7979	0.7792	0.8527	0.8449	0.7793	0.8539
X+R+P	0.8444	0.8408	0.7602	0.8662	0.8647	0.8540	0.8707
X+R+I	0.8485	0.8512	0.7281	0.8663	0.8639	0.8495	0.8687
X+P+I	0.8635	0.8459	0.7893	0.8691	0.8649	0.8420	0.8690
R+P+I	0.8235	0.8210	0.7086	0.8522	0.8437	0.8214	0.8608
X+R+P+I	0.8485	0.8455	0.7554	0.8668	0.8653	0.8477	0.8715

F Execution environment

The same Windows/WSL machine used for the reported capacity test was inspected on October 19, 2026. The installation reports Ubuntu 26.04.1 LTS, kernel `6.18.54.1-microsoft-standard-WSL2`, Python 3.11.17, and PyTorch `2.11.0+cu128` (CUDA build 12.8). Hardware comprises an Intel Core i7-11700K with 16 logical CPUs and an NVIDIA RTX 3080 with 10 GiB VRAM; the host has 32 GB RAM, with approximately 24 GiB allocated to WSL and 8 GiB swap. The reported inference capacity test used the CPU, not CUDA. These versions document the inspected installation; the archived timing and memory trace, rather than a new benchmark, supplies the reported performance measurements.

G External rater backgrounds and procedure

The original human-evaluation study reports three experienced university raters. The Korea-based rater had more than 20 years of teaching experience, including a decade of university pronunciation instruction and speaking assessment. The Japan-based rater had nearly 30 years of teaching experience and more than 10 years as a Cambridge English speaking assessor. The China-based rater had nearly 20 years of experience, including high-stakes speech rating and university speaking assessment in an international joint-degree program. All three held professorial positions, as confirmed by the study author.

Before evaluating the source recordings, the raters jointly assessed separate Stella recordings spanning proficiency levels and discussed discrepancies to establish shared criteria for segmental accuracy, fluency, and prosody. They then scored the 306 source recordings independently in randomized order, blinded to participant identity and automated scores. Ratings used a 0–100 scale in five-point increments, with communicative-effectiveness anchors labelled “High Intelligibility” above 85 and “Low Intelligibility” below 40. These are the documented general scale anchors, not a newly constructed analytic rubric for each dimension. The original study’s authors served as its raters; their ratings were reused as the external reference for the present model evaluation. One recording was subsequently excluded for excessive duration, leaving the matched 305-recording cohort. Human calibration used separate recordings and did not fit or calibrate any automated scorer.